

What's the long term plan of Generative AI if it is bound to worsen the environment yet make the rich richer?

Posted by u/ordinary_shazzamm • 0 points • 21 comments

[<https://www.theguardian.com/environment/2026/jan/29/gas-power-ai-climate>]
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Now I understand how much of this can be facts and how much can be the usual fear mongering.

If the U.S. Government doesn't actively invest in or promote Clean Energy then isn't this likely going to make things worse for the middle class?

The Middle class is already losing it's purchasing power year over year, in addition to costs of worsening climate.

What are your thoughts on Generative AI's demand of electricity compared to it's practical use cases?

Comments

u/PickleBabyJr • 1 points • 2026-01-30 06:19 UTC

Feudalism, baby! Get ready to be enslaved!

u/Awkward_Forever9752 • 1 points • 2026-01-29 17:32 UTC

The plan for AI is to destroy the political power of the US middle class.

There will be other use cases, but this is what the money is going towards.

u/I_pee_in_shower • 1 points • 2026-01-29 17:06 UTC

It will also help make non-rich people rich. It will devalue people that have a skill that is transferable to automation, as it always has. From an AI perspective you can't split the pie with the Middle class line.

It will be more about whether you are (and how much) AI proficient. Or you can be a plumber, or one of these trades that are responsible to replace today. Middle class workers that don't adapt will make less over time on average. Those that exceed the mean by a chunk will increase their earnings over time.

As far as the impact it has on the planet itself, I can't think of a good strategy. Start putting data centers in space that run on solar power?

u/rkozik89 • 1 points • 2026-01-29 16:23 UTC

Wait for the bubble to burst, pick a bottom you are comfortable with, and put money into stocks that pay dividends but have boring yet essential products and services. Then just play the waiting game.

u/Puzzleheaded_Fold466 • 1 points • 2026-01-29 15:53 UTC

Plan ?

What is this novel thing of which you speak ?

What is a "plan" ?

u/No_Sense1206 • -1 points • 2026-01-29 15:41 UTC

doing something about it will make the environment better and rich people gets poorer.

u/No_Sense1206 • -1 points • 2026-01-29 15:41 UTC

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u/Anne_Onim_Ally_2408 • 3 points • 2026-01-29 15:35 UTC

Atlas EON 100 is the prototype. Believing that data center technology will remain stagnant is naive. Anyone who has read even a little about the history of computing knows that the goal is always to optimize resources.

u/Cerulean_IsFancyBlue • 1 points • 2026-01-29 17:47 UTC

That's A goal, and often just a tool. There are many times when that goal takes a backseat.

This is especially true if the costs are partially externalized.

u/ordinary_shazzamm • 2 points • 2026-01-29 15:46 UTC

Yeah thats what I am hoping for as they'll want to optimize the energy output as time goes on but the problem is that this optimization only happens IF it also either SAVES or MAKES them more money

u/davyp82 • 1 points • 2026-01-29 15:32 UTC

It's not Gen AI that fundamentally worsens the environment anymore than its video games or buying too many products in general. It's the type of fuel we use. A mix of nuclear and renewable until eventually all renewables are used would mean pretty much any amount of consumption of anything would be ok, but we are still not taking that path as much as we should, because nuclear has been demonized non stop our whole lives even though CO2 is overwhelmingly more likely to cause a planetary catastrophe than nuclear, regardless of how scary it sounds.

u/ordinary_shazzamm • 2 points • 2026-01-29 15:35 UTC

Nuclear was demonized extensively successfully which just begs the question: when will the tipping point be that reverses that psychosis?

u/Awkward_Forever9752 • 1 points • 2026-01-29 17:36 UTC

Hard to imagine Trump, Tesla or Facebook caring enough about people or any other thing to safely run a nuke.

u/Awkward_Forever9752 • 1 points • 2026-01-29 17:40 UTC

Jeff Bezos does not give a fuck about anyone.

Are you really willing to give him nukes to help him kill off more industries and become a monopoly on all consumer products?

u/davyp82 • 1 points • 2026-01-29 15:40 UTC

When AI saves us from human psychopaths willing to destroy the earth for profit, and subsequently enacts a necessarily safe energy policy. Without AI intervention it's curtains for us. People are scared of AI, whereas I think the worst humans are always destined to lead; never the good ones; and with the destructive potential at their fingertips now and in the future, the only realistic outcome sans an AI genie scenario is absolute self destruction by humanity, so I'm welcoming AI as our only hope.

u/Anne_Onim_Ally_2408 • 1 points • 2026-01-29 15:48 UTC

Long live Roko's basilisk

u/OGLikeablefellow • 2 points • 2026-01-29 15:29 UTC

Spend more money on it by the money havers

u/CarlISagan • 0 points • 2026-01-29 15:20 UTC

Doom.

u/phase_distorter41 • 5 points • 2026-01-29 15:19 UTC

"If the U.S. Government doesn't actively invest in or promote Clean Energy" then its bad for us ai or not.

u/Every_Parsnip_9316 • 0 points • 2026-01-29 15:19 UTC

The whole thing feels like crypto mining 2.0 but with extra steps and better marketing

Honestly most of the "revolutionary" use cases right now are just fancy autocomplete that burns through electricity like there's no tomorrow

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2026-01-29 15:17 UTC

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